dalekanium — clean Windows 11 install: walk-through

Full plan: `M:\Eduardo\repos\prof-workstation\windows\dalekanium\PLAN.md` · Board: ASUS ROG STRIX B450-F · **Del** = firmware setup · **F8** = boot menu

0. Before powering off

☐ Pre-wipe backup done: `F:\dalekanium-prewipe` + system image `F:\WindowsImageBackup`
☐ Both repos committed and pushed
☐ Rufus stick made from the 26H2 ISO: GPT, UEFI (non CSM). Ticked: no MS-account requirement, local account **Eduardo**, skip privacy questions, **no BitLocker auto-encryption**. Unticked: TPM/Secure Boot bypass, "Windows CA 2023 bootloaders", "SkuSiPolicy.p7b"
☐ `wincmd.key` saved in Bitwarden
☐ At hand: Bitwarden master password + 2FA device; GitHub 2FA; UTSA login + MFA phone

1. Firmware (press Del at power-on)

1. F7 for Advanced Mode if needed.
2. Advanced → AMD fTPM configuration → **Firmware TPM**.
3. Boot → CSM → Launch CSM: **Disabled**.
4. Boot → Secure Boot → OS Type: **Windows UEFI mode**.
5. **F10** save & exit, then power **off**.
6. Do **not** update the BIOS.

2. Cables (power off, PSU switch off)

1. **Unplug the SATA cable of the M: SSD** (Crucial MX500 500 GB). It holds the old boot partition and all your data.
2. Unplug both USB drives: F: WD Elements 13 TB, E: WD easystore 4 TB.
3. Leave only the NVMe (C:, Silicon Power 512 GB) and the Rufus stick.

3. Install

1. Power on, **F8**, choose **"UEFI: <USB stick>"**.
2. Language/keyboard: English (US). "Install Windows 11". "I don't have a product key".
3. Edition: **Windows 11 Pro** (matches your licence).
4. Custom install. Delete **every** partition on the one disk (~477 GB) → select the unallocated space → Next.

> **STOP** if setup lists more than one disk: M: is still connected. Power off and unplug it.

4. First setup screens

1. Region US; keyboard US, add **US-International**.
2. Network: wired cable is fine.
3. Local account **Eduardo**: set the password (+ security questions).
4. Every privacy toggle **off**. Decline every offer: Phone Link, OneDrive backup ("skip"/"don't back up"), Office/Game Pass trials.

5. Reconnect and check

1. Shut down. Reconnect the M: SSD and both USB drives. Boot.
2. Win+X → Disk Management. Letters must be **M:** MEDIA, **F:** Elements, **E:** easystore. Fix with "Change Drive Letter". Leave the old 1 GB "System Reserved" partition on the M: disk alone.
3. Settings → System → Activation: **Active** (digital licence).

6. Back to git (in `cmd`)

1. `winget install -e --id Git.Git`
2. `winget install -e --id Bitwarden.Bitwarden`. Log in; Settings → enable **SSH agent**.
3. `services.msc` → "OpenSSH Authentication Agent" → Startup type **Disabled**.
4. `setx HOME M:\Eduardo`, then open a **new** cmd window.
5. `ssh -T git@github.com`: approve in Bitwarden; expect "Hi eduenez!".
6. `cd /d M:\Eduardo\repos\prof-workstation && git pull`

> Then: install the Claude desktop app, link this computer, connect `M:\Eduardo\repos`, and say: "*dalekanium is reinstalled; continue with PLAN.md, Phase 5.*" Don't install the sync apps until then (old folders get renamed first).

If something goes wrong

- **Stick not in the F8 menu:** CSM is off, so only UEFI sticks show. Remake the stick with GPT/UEFI.
- **"Secure Boot violation":** set Secure Boot → Disabled, install, turn it back on later.
- **"This PC can't run Windows 11":** fTPM isn't enabled (step 1.2).
- **Microsoft account demanded anyway:** unplug the network cable at that screen. If there's still no local option, stop and ask Claude from another device.
- **Escape hatch:** the old system image is on F:. Nothing is encrypted, so all disks stay readable from any computer.